Early microcomputers were larger than todays consoles.

programming and implementing their own applications.

This attribute sadly fell by the wayside during the 1980s after the release of Apple's enterprise applications for the Apple II microcomputer - which then began to redefine the appeal of microcomputers for modern day consumers. Within the next couple of decades the idea of a computer enthusiasts microcomputer was replaced by products like mobiles, tablets, handheld game consoles and laptops. No longer were consumers engaging with the technology, now it was all about applications. It was only with the release of the Raspberry Pi that the world began to take notice of the latent demands in the market for old-school enthusiast driven computing. This by no means implies that Raspberry was the first microcomputer of the current era - in fact, there remain many vital products that appear to compete with Raspberry Pi, such as the Beaglebone, Beagleboard, Intel Edison and Intel Galileo. But in the face of such competition the Raspberry Pi has remained very popular going on to sell millions of units. We explain why.

Clarifying the Competition

Before taking a look at the Raspberry Pi's closest direct competitor we should clarify certain misconceptions. Many people think that some Arduino boards or certain Intel products can be compared to the Raspberry Pi in terms of function. Nothing could be further from the truth. There is a fundamental difference between the Arduino and the Pi - the former is a microcontroller, while the latter is a micro computer. The microcontroller is only a compo-